DSEH004 · PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT AND EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

Gallup Q12 and the Practitioner Tradition

Week 2 · Lecture 2 · Unit II · What survey instruments measure, what they predict, and how to adapt them

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L2 · COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

If a survey predicts profit, it must be measuring engagement.

Agree or disagree. What else could it be measuring?

The Gallup Q12

BUCKINGHAM AND COFFMAN (1999)

Origin

Twelve items distilled from Gallup's research on what distinguishes strong work units and managers.

HARTER, SCHMIDT AND HAYES (2002)

The evidence

Across 7,939 business units in 36 companies, unit engagement related to customer satisfaction, productivity, profit, turnover and safety.

What the items actually measure

MACEY AND SCHNEIDER (2008)

Conditions, not the state

Items such as knowing what is expected or having materials describe conditions for engagement, not engagement itself.

LEVEL MATTERS

Level of analysis

Evidence is at business unit level. Applying it to individuals risks the ecological fallacy: a group average is not a fact about each member.

HARTER ET AL. (2010)

Causality

Longitudinal work suggests perceptions predict later outcomes more than the reverse, though both directions exist.

L2 · THREE INSTRUMENTS, THREE THEORIES

What each one is built to see

INSTRUMENT	WHAT IT MEASURES	BEST USED FOR
Gallup Q12	Manager controlled conditions	Unit diagnosis, manager action plans
UWES	The state: vigor, dedication, absorption	Measuring engagement itself
Kahn's conditions	Meaningfulness, safety, availability	Explaining why engagement is absent

Harter et al. (2002); Schaufeli and Bakker (2004); Kahn (1990)

Does an item mean the same thing in Bhiwandi as in Boston?

VANDENBERG AND LANCE (2000)

Measurement invariance

Before comparing groups, show that items relate to the construct in the same way in each group.

BHATNAGAR (2007)

Indian evidence

Engagement and its link to retention have been studied among Indian ITES employees.

CULTURAL MEANING

Translation is not enough

An item about praise from a supervisor may carry different weight under high power distance.

L2 · PRACTICAL EXERCISE

Find the gaps in the Bharat Textiles baseline survey

1 **Map**
For each Q12 type condition, find the item in the baseline that measures it.

2 **Mark**
Mark the conditions with no item at all.

3 **Predict**
Say what a manager could not act on because the item is missing.

L2 · CLOSE

If you could add only one item to the Bharat Textiles survey, which would it be, and which theory justifies it?

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